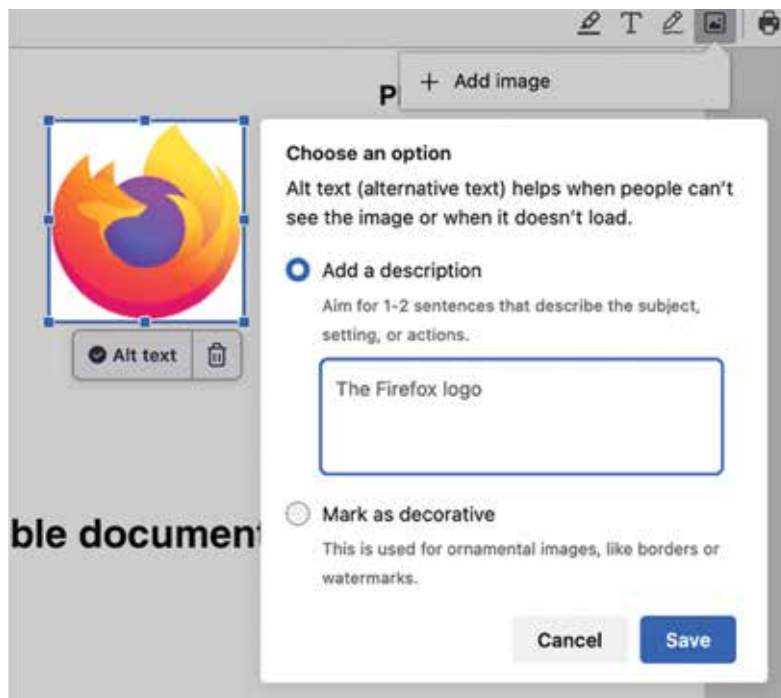


Firefox 130 is available for public testing

With the rollout of Firefox 129 to users worldwide on all supported platforms, Mozilla has promoted Firefox 130 to the beta channel, making it available for public testing. This upcoming release brings several new features and improvements.

Firefox 130 appears to be a modest summer update, with one of its key changes being the default enabling of overscroll animations on Linux for scrollable areas. Additionally, the built-in translation feature has been enhanced, allowing users to translate selected portions of text into different languages even after a full-page translation has been performed.



A notable addition in Firefox 130 beta is the introduction of a 'Firefox Labs' section within the settings. This new section provides users with an easy way to enable experimental web features. Currently, Firefox 130 includes options to activate an AI chatbot, an auto-open feature for picture-in-picture when switching tabs, support for service workers in the debugger panel, and an address bar feature that shows results during IME (input method editor) composition.

These new features and improvements make Firefox 130 an interesting update for users who enjoy exploring and testing the latest capabilities of their browser.

For web developers, the upcoming Firefox release is set to bring significant updates, including support for Curve25519 primitives in the WebCryptoAPI, enabling features like Ed25519 signatures and X25519 key generation. Additionally, the much-anticipated Cookie Banner Blocker feature, which automatically instructs Firefox to refuse cookie banners, continues to be available in the beta version.

Mozilla has scheduled the official release of Firefox 130 for September 3, 2024, alongside Firefox 128.2 ESR and Firefox 115.15 ESR. In the meantime, users can test Firefox 130 by downloading the latest beta build from the official website. However, it is important to remember that this pre-release version is not intended for production use.

Raspberry Pi Pico 2 is now available

element14 has announced the availability of the Raspberry Pi Pico 2, a powerful and compact microcontroller board developed by Raspberry Pi. Maintaining the same dimensions as the original Pico, the Raspberry Pi Pico 2 introduces significant performance improvements, thanks to the new RP2350 microcontroller, also designed by Raspberry Pi. The RP2350 microcontroller offers several advancements over its predecessor, the RP2040, which debuted in 2021. The upgrades include a 150MHz system clock, dual Arm Cortex-M33 cores, dual Hazard3 RISC-V cores, 520KB of SRAM, and 8KB of on-chip antifuse OTP storage. The microcontroller also features enhanced security with Arm TrustZone for Cortex-M, and improved power efficiency.

The Raspberry Pi Pico 2 is equipped with 4MB of onboard flash memory, doubling the storage capacity of the original Pico. The RP2350 microcontroller integrates key security features such as OTP for boot configuration and key storage, ROM support for stage 2 bootloader authentication using a public key fingerprint in OTP, and infrastructure support for Arm TrustZone. Additionally, it includes a comprehensive set of peripherals: 2 UARTs, 2 SPI controllers, 2 I2C controllers, 24 PWM channels, a USB 1.1 controller with host and device support, and 12 PIO state machines. The upgraded QSPI interface supports double-banked cache for enhanced hit bandwidth and includes flash and PSRAM support, burst transfers, odd clock divisors, and address translation.

Eben Upton, CEO of Raspberry Pi, noted that the RP2350 microcontroller and Raspberry Pi Pico 2 deliver higher performance, lower power consumption, and enhanced security, offering a versatile platform for innovation and experimentation. Simon Wade, senior global product manager for single board computing at element14, emphasised the ongoing popularity of Raspberry Pi products and expressed confidence that the improved features of the Raspberry Pi Pico 2 would excite enthusiasts worldwide.

The Raspberry Pi Pico 2 is now available for order from element14 in the APAC region.